Find the move

The Immortal Game: Anderssen v Kieseritzky, London 1851. Three questions ask what Anderssen played; two are puzzles with one answer.

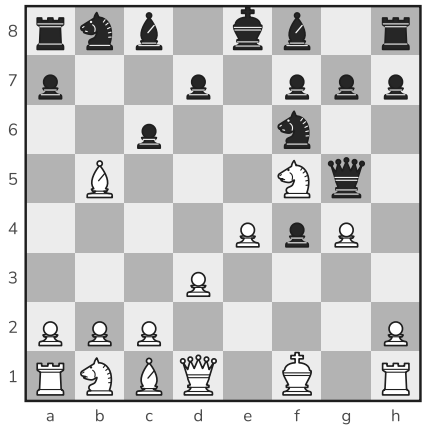
Grown-up _____

Child _____

1 White to play — Anderssen's move

After 10...Nf6 (move 11)

Your bishop on b5 is attacked. Anderssen left it there. What did he play instead?



Who found it first?

☐ Grown-up

☐ Child

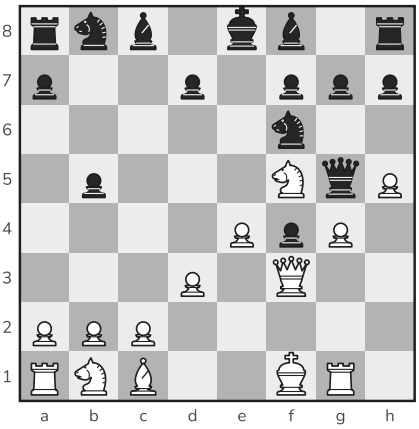
Your answer:

_____

2 Black to play — White's threat

After 14.Qf3 (Black to play)

What is White threatening?



Who found it first?

☐ Grown-up

☐ Child

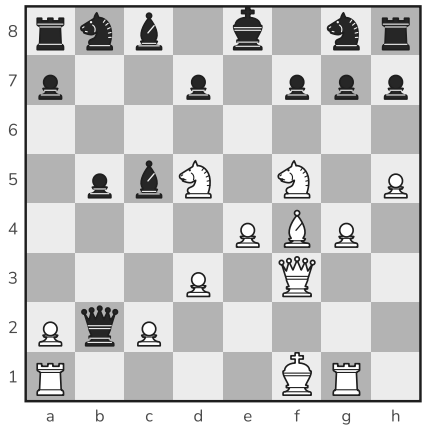
Your answer:

_____

3 White to play — Anderssen's move

After 17...Qxb2 (move 18)

Both your rooks are attacked. What bold move did Anderssen play?



Who found it first?

☐ Grown-up

☐ Child

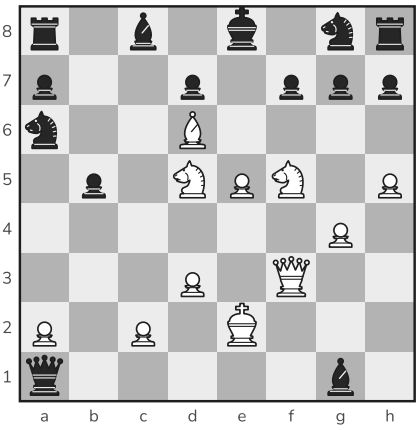
Your answer:

_____

4 White to play — Checkmate in 3

After 20...Na6 (move 21)

Anderssen's finish: find the checkmate in three moves.



Who found it first?

☐ Grown-up

☐ Child

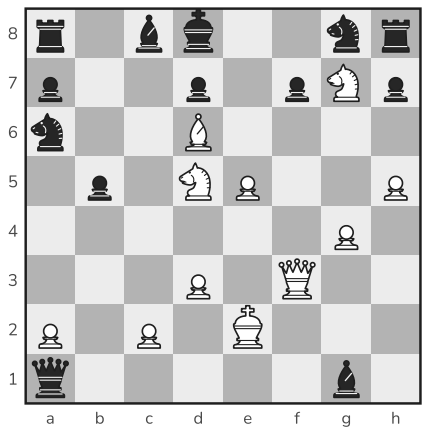
Your answer:

_____

5 White to play — Checkmate in 2

After 21...Kd8 (move 22)

One move later: find the checkmate in two.



Who found it first?

☐ Grown-up

☐ Child

Your answer:

_____

Final score

Grown-up _____ **/ 5**

Child _____ **/ 5**

Two real puzzles. Questions 4 and 5 have one answer each. Questions 1 to 3 ask what Anderssen actually played.

The answers and the whole game are on page 2.

RankUp Chess is an offline chess app for children. It's free to play; its puzzle packs are part of a one-time upgrade. **stillwareltd.com/rankupchess**

Game: Anderssen v Kieseritzky, London 1851. Sources: Kieseritzky in La Régence (1851); R. Hübner (1995); G. Kasparov (2003).

The answers, and the whole game

Read these once you've both had a go. The moves in chess notation follow each answer.

---

1. Rook to g1. Anderssen let the bishop go: the rook guards the pawn on g4 and helps box in the black queen. 11.Rg1
2. Bishop takes f4, and the black queen has nowhere to go; and the pawn to e5, hitting the knight on f6 and opening the queen's line to the rook on a8. 15.Bxf4 and e5
3. Bishop to d6, letting Black take both rooks. Hübner shows that rook to e1, bishop to e3 and pawn to d4 also win here. 18.Bd6 (also 18.d4, 18.Be3, 18.Re1)
4. Knight takes g7, check; the king must go to d8. Queen to f6, check; the knight takes the queen. Bishop to e7, checkmate. 21.Nxg7+ Kd8 22.Qf6+ Nxf6 23.Be7#
5. Queen to f6, check. The knight takes it, or blocks on e7; either way the bishop lands on e7, checkmate. 22.Qf6+ Nxf6 23.Be7# (22...Ne7 23.Bxe7#)

The whole game

Adolf Anderssen v Lionel Kieseritzky, London 1851

1. e4 e5
2. f4 exf4
3. Bc4 Qh4+
4. Kf1 b5
5. Bxb5 Nf6
6. Nf3 Qh6
7. d3 Nh5
8. Nh4 Qg5
9. Nf5 c6
10. g4 Nf6
11. Rg1 cxb5
12. h4 Qg6
13. h5 Qg5
14. Qf3 Ng8
15. Bxf4 Qf6
16. Nc3 Bc5
17. Nd5 Qxb2
18. Bd6 Bxg1
19. e5 Qxa1+
20. Ke2 Na6
21. Nxg7+ Kd8
22. Qf6+ Nxf6
23. Be7#

The story

White gave away a bishop, two rooks and the queen, and mated with two knights and a bishop.

A casual game, played during the London tournament of 1851, which Anderssen won.

Kieseritzky published it himself in *La Régence* that July. His report ends with his resignation after move 20; the finish was probably announced by Anderssen.

Ernst Falkbeer named it "the Immortal Game" in 1855.

> **Before you take something free, look at what it pulls away from your king.**